



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Benin: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-20

Edition of 2026-08-20 • 90 systems and instruments tracked, 5 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-20 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 90 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 55 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-20, 13 did not, 17 carry no stated baseline, and 5 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 188 sources for this place in the window — 42 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 146 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The shape check above passes at full width, so what follows compares the whole twelve months rather than a shorter period wearing a longer label.

Not one existing system climbed a maturity band — nothing went from planned to piloting or piloting to implemented — and nothing stalled except the e-procurement rebuild, whose first tender failed. What the movement table records is rules and reach appearing on top of a stack that was already there.

Benin's foundational layers were all in place and operating when the window opened, and there was no lower band for them to leave. What the year added was rules, reach and disclosure on top of a stack that was already built.

The national digital programme stood at [0.62% of credits ordonnancé at 30 April 2026](#), and no full-year executed figure exists for any Benin digital programme in any year.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
5G networks	One 5G operator (MTN, 2024)	Two operators, after Moov Africa Bénin	ADVANCED
National fibre backbone	In service	More than 3,000 km underpinning the service estate	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Sovereign cloud and national cyber authority	Did not exist	Recommended only; neither exists	ADVANCED
National data centre	In operation	Operating; no capacity, tier or tenancy figure held	NO CHANGE

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National digital-security stack	In place (2020)	Coordinated through ASIN and the CNIN, under the Malabo and Budapest conventions	NO CHANGE
Attack surface of the online service estate	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 230 services delivered online, about 40 priority structures under oversight (2026-06)	Baseline not held

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
SECURROUTE road-enforcement data platform	Did not exist	Being extended for full interoperability with the national exchange	ADVANCED

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Cotonou cyber-hub programme	Programme running (2025-06)	Incubator, statewide EBIOS framework, crisis exercise and 300 unit heads trained	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Free roaming with Senegal and Togo	Did not exist	Free roaming with Senegal and Togo, free incoming calls for 30 days	ADVANCED
Participation in regional cybercrime enforcement	Did not exist	Participant in the regional takedown	ADVANCED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National vulnerability report	Did not exist	878 vulnerabilities over 2021-2024, 23% critical; institutional compliance 6% to 87%	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Internet freedom ranking	BASELINE NOT HELD	4th in Africa on a 2026 internet-freedom assessment	Baseline not held

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Mobile data pricing	BASELINE NOT HELD	995 FCFA a gigabyte (2023), from 4,000 in 2016	Baseline not held

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
WARDIP second-phase regional digital financing	Did not exist	US\$137m for Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone across three pillars	ADVANCED

No position in this section changed maturity band. The security strategy, the fibre backbone and the data centre all held. What arrived was a second 5G operator, free roaming with Senegal and Togo, US\$137m of regional broadband financing, the [first national vulnerability report](#), and participation in a regional cybercrime takedown.

The security of the online service estate was stated as a problem in June 2026 — more than 230 services, about 40 priority structures under oversight — and the sovereign cloud and national cyber authority urged to answer it entered as a recommendation and nothing more.

Digital public infrastructure

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
AFIS fingerprint system wired to the regional police exchange	Did not exist	Connected to the ECOWAS SIPAO police data exchange	ADVANCED

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Electronic international waybill	Did not exist	Live at the Port of Cotonou	ADVANCED
Xroad-BJ national data exchange	Operating (2025-08)	73 members, 176 information systems, 512 services; 138.17m requests cumulatively	ADVANCED, IN TRAFFIC

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Customs system migration	Migrated (2025-02)	44 of 49 offices, with more than 30bn CFA collected	NO CHANGE
BIC-UEMOA credit information bureau	Not held	Operating across all eight UEMOA states with 321 data providers, about 48 million contracts and more than 20 million active borrowers; at its first Cotonou data forum on 23 July 2026 the finance ministry framed data quality as the route to cutting credit-approval turnaround to 48 hours	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Diaspora biometric passport renewal platform	Did not exist	Available in more than 80 countries, renewals reported at about 15 minutes	ADVANCED
Foundational biometric identity	Biometric enrolment near-complete (2025-08)	98-99% biometric enrolment; 7.7m numbers and 6.1m certificates issued free	ADVANCED, IN ISSUANCE RATHER THAN IN COVERAGE
Citizen mobile wallet	Planned (2025-06)	Still planned; no build reported	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Cashless motorway tolls	Did not exist	Cashless tolling live	ADVANCED
Mobile money	Operating (2024)	11.65m active accounts; one operator holds about 51% of accounts and 83% of revenue	ADVANCED, IN ACCOUNTS; CONCENTRATION UNCHANGED
Regional instant payment rail	Rail launched across all eight member states (2025-09-30)	Fully interconnected and free domestically	ADVANCED
Regional central bank digital currency	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional e-CFA in pilot	Baseline not held

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Birth registration	About 22% of births registered nationally	Pilot at 76.56%; generalisation slipped 3 to 4 months into consolidation	ADVANCED, IN THE PILOT BUT NOT IN GENERALISATION
e-Foncier national land cadastre	12 communes, 491,420 parcels (2025-02)	445,695 parcels nationally; the certificate mandatory for any transaction	ADVANCED
National Register of Natural Persons	Operating (2025-08)	80+ institutions, about 200,000 authentications a day, 25m eKYC verifications in 2025	ADVANCED, IN VOLUME
Population register as the electoral roll	Statutory basis in place, untested at a presidential poll	Compiled and managed the April 2026 list; ECOWAS and AU missions satisfied	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
ACTIA academic records platform (Université d'Abomey-Calavi)	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Mandatory for all requests for degree certificates, transcripts, enrolment certificates and diploma duplicates at UAC, retiring counter-based processing; no fee schedule, turnaround time or appeal route published	ADVANCED
e-Procurement platform	Previous system retired by décret 2025-169 (2025-04)	Old platform retired, new one not built	STALLED, THE FIRST TENDER FAILED
Justice-sector digitalisation plan 2026-2033	Did not exist	Citizen case-tracking portal and secure hosting committed; no budget, sequencing or implementing agency	ADVANCED
Portail national des services publics	Live with fewer services (2025-06)	More than 230 services delivered online on the national exchange	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Extension of the biometric register to foreigners and Afro-descendants	Did not exist	Residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers	ADVANCED
Tax measures pushing merchants onto digital rails	In force (2025-01)	Levy plus the 2026 rectifying finance law's digital taxes	ADVANCED
Décret 2020-209 instituting the exchange	In force (2020-03-18)	In force; the signed decree now on file	NO CHANGE
Identity-linked SIM registration	In force (2025-04)	In force	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Mandatory digitisation of paper records	Did not exist	Every state structure required to move archives onto digital tools; no deadline, budget or compliance mechanism	ADVANCED
National DPI roadmap	Did not exist	In draft on a once-only principle; the agency frames the hard part as governance	ADVANCED
Single-agency identity governance	In place (2017)	Identity, population, civil and electoral registers under one agency	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign membership	Did not exist	16th African member	ADVANCED
Smart Africa cross-border data exchange	Did not exist	Cross-border digital identity pilot running with Rwanda and Ghana, eighteen more countries said to be joining	ADVANCED
Trilateral border-modernisation steering committee	Did not exist	Nigeria, Cameroon and Benin customs administrations committed to implement Beitbridge-model border modernisation on the Sèmè-Kraké and Mfum-Ekok corridors	ADVANCED
ECOWAS-standard biometric identity card	In issue (2020)	In issue	NO CHANGE

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National Root Certification Authority and trust services	Established 2025-07-17, not yet operating	National root authority and trust services operating	ADVANCED
PASI and PDAIE interoperability referentials	Did not exist	Under consultation	ADVANCED
Published conditions of access to the exchange	Did not exist	A convention per exchange and authority authorisation before first connection; no fee schedule or processing time	ADVANCED
Cadre d'interopérabilité	In force	In force; its governance clause reports to the President	NO CHANGE
GovTech Maturity Index standing	BASELINE NOT HELD	2025 top performer, alongside Algeria, South Africa and Nigeria	Baseline not held

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Consumer redress for failed mobile-money transactions	Did not exist	A financial-sector redress body stood up; complaints about failed transactions unresolved	ADVANCED
Free identity-card distribution by civil society	Did not exist	130,000+ free cards in eight months, exposing failed fingerprints and dead enrolment numbers	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Domestic payment aggregator	Did not exist	A home-grown rail with more than 13,000 merchants	ADVANCED

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Public reporting of exchange usage	Did not exist	Request volumes, members, systems and services published	ADVANCED
National statistics office as data custodian	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named among four offices being displaced as primary data producers (2026-03)	Baseline not held

The identity system did not change band — implemented on 2025-08-01 and implemented now, at [about 98–99% biometric coverage](#) throughout — while issuance kept climbing beneath it. The exchange, instituted in 2020, likewise held its band while usage grew past 138 million requests.

What entered the record inside the window is almost entirely governance and reach. The exchange gained published [conditions of access](#), interoperability referentials, a root certification authority and a cross-border mission with Rwanda and Ghana. Identity gained a residents file by law, an AFIS wired to the regional police exchange, a diaspora passport-renewal platform, and its first use as the electoral roll at a presidential poll.

[Birth registration entered the record as a problem](#) — about 2.5m births declared against under 1m registered — with a pilot fix at 76.56% whose generalisation slipped. And the e-procurement platform entered as a decree retiring the old system followed by a failed tender.

Payments run on a regional rail. Banks and mobile money were fully interconnected in May 2026.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Data-localisation law	Did not exist	Committed only; no draft, scope or timetable on file	ADVANCED

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Machinery of government for digital	Ministry as previously constituted	Renamed Transformation Digitale et Innovation with an AI-strategy mandate; budget codes moved	ADVANCED
Presidential programme 2026-2033 digital commitments	Did not exist	Commits to a data-localisation law, supercomputers and a data-monetising platform; no budget or sequencing	ADVANCED
Stratégie numérique 2031	Did not exist	In drafting with external facilitation	ADVANCED
Vision Bénin 2060 digital pillar	Did not exist	Digital pillar published	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Cotonou Declaration on a single digital market	Did not exist	Ministerial commitments to 90% affordable broadband by 2030 and interoperable identity and payments	ADVANCED
Data-protection cooperation conventions	Did not exist	Conventions with Senegal and Mali	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Data protection authority	Operating (2025-08)	907 files, 64 control missions, 14 sanctioned cases; no algorithmic-audit tooling or budget	ADVANCED, IN CASELOAD
Enforcement against the electoral agency	BASELINE NOT HELD	Extraneous fields required to be stripped from the electoral roll before publication	Baseline not held

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Data-protection authority AI policy	Did not exist	A dedicated AI policy with strict purpose limitation	ADVANCED

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Open Government Partnership national action plan	Did not exist	Co-creation opened eighteen months after joining, with commune-level consultation	ADVANCED
Budget transparency	BASELINE NOT HELD	Open Budget Survey 2025: 77/100 transparency, 52 participation, 72 oversight	Baseline not held

No instrument here changed band.

The data-protection authority held position as an operating regulator throughout the window. Its [2025 report](#), its AI policy and its cooperation conventions all entered the record inside the window as evidence of an institution already working, not as its arrival.

The rest of the section is a policy stack being rebuilt around a new government. Vision 2060's digital pillar, the 2031 strategy, the presidential programme for 2026–2033 and a renamed ministry with an explicit AI mandate were all published between February and May, and a decree moved the budget programme codes so that any series keyed on ministry breaks at 24 May 2026.

Two commitments are stated and unevidenced: a data-localisation law with no draft, scope or timetable, and a government AI super app listed among foundations the programme already claims.

On disclosure, an [Open Budget Survey score reached 77/100](#), fifth globally, from 1/100 in 2012.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
AI, drone and geospatial malaria programme	Did not exist	Incidence down 38% and mortality down 39% across 2022-2024	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Six-country francophone AI-governance framework	Did not exist	Six-country framework in development, Benin co-leading	ADVANCED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Generative-AI compliance regime for public agents	Did not exist	Census of users, a binding charter and no-training contract clauses; concedes the sovereignty risk remains	ADVANCED

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Fon-language voice AI	Did not exist	The first voice-to-voice AI in Fon, across Benin, Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire	ADVANCED

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National AI and big-data strategy	In force (2023)	In force	NO CHANGE

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Domestic content-verification platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Checks text, images, audio and video, including AI-generated content	Baseline not held

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Domestic AI authorship and frugal-AI argument	BASELINE NOT HELD	A strategy co-author's frugal-AI argument, published 2026-07	Baseline not held

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National AI Olympiad	Did not exist	First edition held	ADVANCED

No maturity changed. The national AI strategy has run since 2023 and held position throughout; everything else in the section arrived.

Mother-tongue voice AI in Fon in June 2025, built for service access rather than for demonstration. A [compliance regime for generative AI in the public service](#) in June 2026 that begins by admitting officials already use these tools outside any framework, and that concedes contractual terms cannot close the sovereignty risk. A malaria programme with published outcome figures. A first national olympiad.

Two rows carry no baseline: the content-verification platform, founded in 2025, and the domestic authorship and frugal-AI argument that closed the window.

One entry in this section is *Not held*. A government AI super app is counted among the presidential programme's existing foundations and nothing on file establishes that it exists.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital usage growth	BASELINE NOT HELD	Rising usage in the regulator's 2025 report, with no disaggregation by gender or rurality	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital access to public services	BASELINE NOT HELD	At least 75% of identification services accessed digitally (2025)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National tele-teaching platform	Did not exist	Authorised, not built	ADVANCED
Sèmè City skills hub network	Operating (2025-10)	Hub network plus a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week	NO CHANGE
State RSSI certification programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 85 officers trained (2026-08) against a target of 100 qualified RSSI by end-2026, on CEH and ISO 27001 with practical work at the national Cyber Range; intake opened beyond central government to local authorities, state enterprises and the private sector	<i>Baseline not held</i>

No position changed band.

The delivery rows are all arrivals: a national tele-teaching platform authorised for 2026–27, the skills hub network and a francophone training programme.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
MEF digitalisation support project (BOAD)	Did not exist	XOF 19.5bn (US\$32.5m) BOAD loan modernising the finance ministry's data centre, La Poste du Benin's information system and the DGFD's SGIFD/SIRH systems, in implementation (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Canadian financing for the digital transformation of women-led businesses	Baseline not held	CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa; no implementing partner, start date or duration is named	BASELINE NOT HELD

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Quarterly budget execution reports (RAPEX)	Published quarterly (2024-12)	Published quarterly, with a citizen version; latest instalment held covers to 31 March 2025	NO CHANGE
Budget standing of the digital institutions	BASELINE NOT HELD	The data-protection authority carries its own line (488.3m to 738.3m FCFA); the digital and identity agencies carry none	Baseline not held
Execution of the national digital budget programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Programme 111 Numérique at 0.62% of credits ordonnancé (2026-04-30), against 15.43% across all programmes	Baseline not held

The first per-programme execution figures Benin has ever published arrived inside the window, showing the [national digital programme at 0.62% of credits ordonnancé](#) at 30 April 2026 against 15.43% across all programmes.

The reading of the estimates volumes established a budget line for the data-protection authority, none for the agency running the CSIRT, the data centre and the PKI, none for the identity agency, and no appearance at all by the telecoms regulator.

Two entries are *Not held* for the same reason — the performance reports the organic budget law requires have never been published, and no audited figure exists for any digital line — so nothing here can be checked against outturn.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Government AI super app	Any statement, screenshot, service listing or usage figure establishing that the 'Super App IA Gouvernementale' counted among the presidential programme's existing foundations exists, is deployed or is used.	2026-08-04
India digital cooperation	A bilateral MoU, DPI cooperation programme document or ministerial readout naming a Benin-India digital instrument.	2026-08-04
Annual performance reports required by the organic budget law	A Rapport annuel de performance for any gestion; none has ever been published, so no full-year executed figure exists for any Benin digital programme.	2026-08-04
Audited figures for any digital budget line	A Cour des comptes rapport sur l'exécution des lois de finances after 2023, or the published text of loi n° 2026-06 settling gestion 2024.	2026-08-04
Dedicated AI legislation	A bill, decree or law regulating artificial intelligence specifically, or an official statement that one is in preparation.	2026-08-10

Five subjects carry no reliable position at either end, all probed once on 2026-08-04, and two returned a route.

The decree instituting the national data exchange is served as a PDF from the operator's own media host, which an earlier attempt on the government secretariat and a ministry site did not reach. Until it lands, everything stated here about the exchange's legal basis rests on a framework document that cites the decree without reproducing it. The second is the budget directorate's published execution reports, the only published route to executed figures.

Three absences stand dated: no Cour des comptes execution report after 2023, no Benin–India digital instrument in India's own list of twenty-four partner states, and nothing establishing the government AI super app.

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.